



PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Trust Engine

Instant refunds for honest customers. **A speed bump for fraud.**

A refund verification system for quick-commerce platforms

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THE PROBLEM

Fast refunds or careful checks?

Today, platforms have to pick one — and both choices hurt.

No-questions refunds

Customers are happy — money back in seconds.

But abuse is easy: free money for anyone who asks, and photos get reused across accounts.

Review everything

Fraud drops — a person checks each claim.

But honest people wait days, and agents drown in claims that were fine all along.

The same policy that delights customers is the one that invites fraud.

WHY IT MATTERS

The money and the frustration

10–15%

of refund spend lost to abuse in retail & quick commerce (industry, directional)

Days

honest customers wait when every claim is checked by hand

Most

of an agent's time goes to claims that turn out to be genuine

“No-questions” refund policies get shared and gamed — the same “damaged item” photo shows up on account after account.

Directional framing for the problem, not measured results.

Is this problem real?

True problem

Speed and safety pull against each other — today it's one or the other.

Evidence

Known abuse losses, the same photo reused across accounts, steady slow-refund complaints.

Value created

Fast, fair refunds for customers; less fraud paid out; agents focus on the real edge cases.

Who feels it

Customers, ops agents, finance, and the platform — all at once.

Why now

Order volume is booming, phone photos are everywhere, and simple photo checks are finally practical.

Two people, same app — different goals

● **Priya** — honest customer

“My paneer arrived spoiled. I just want my ₹340 back, now.”

● **Rahul** — refund abuser

Reuses the same photo to claim refunds again and again.

● **Sana** — trust & safety agent

Buried in claims that are mostly genuine.

● **Arjun** — finance / risk lead

Watching refund costs climb every quarter.

Goals and non-goals

Goals

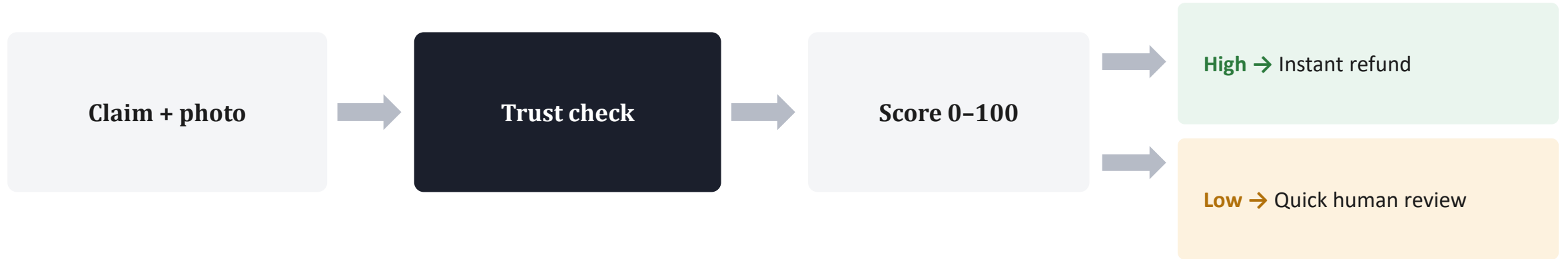
- Instant refunds for clearly honest claims
- Catch obvious abuse the moment a claim is made
- Send only the tricky few to a human
- Keep every decision easy to explain

Non-goals

- Not replacing human judgment on hard cases
- Not auto-rejecting customers — low trust means “review,” never a hard “no”
- Not a payments, chargeback, or identity system
- Not storing customers' photos

THE IDEA

A quick trust check on every claim



- Most refund claims are honest — approve them instantly if we can spot the few that aren't.
- High score with no red flags → refund credited on the spot.
- Low score or a red flag → fast human review, not a rejection.
- Either way, the customer feels one smooth flow.

HOW IT DECIDES

What the trust check looks at

Account history

Is this a normal, established customer?

Claim details

Does the claim make sense — amount, timing, proof?

Risk flags

Anything our systems already flagged?

Photo — real damage?

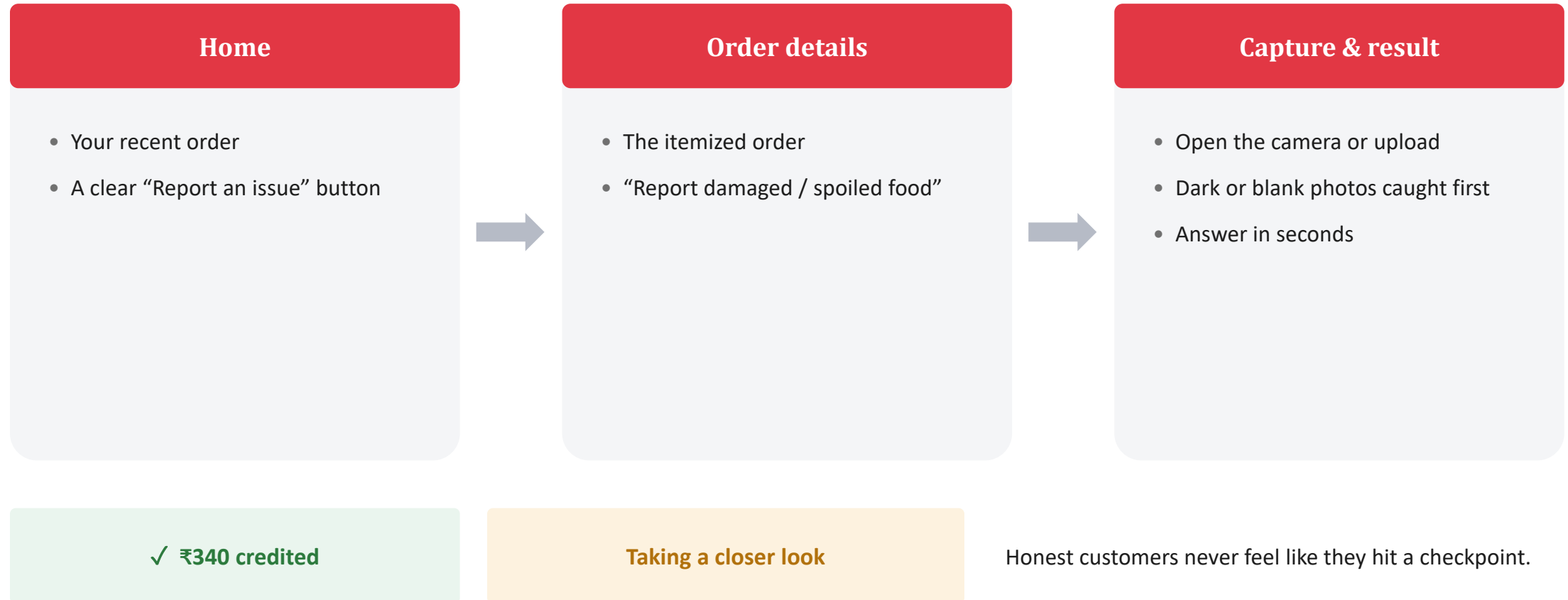
Does it actually show spoiled or damaged food?

Photo — genuine?

A real photo — not edited, computer-made, or reused from another account?

The two photo checks count the most — that's where fraud usually hides.

Three taps: report, snap, done



Metrics and guardrails

Illustrative targets

>90%

instant approval for honest claims

>80%

fraud caught at claim time

<1s

to a decision

>60%

fewer claims reach an agent

Guardrails — don't cross these

- Honest claims wrongly sent to review: keep under 5%.
- Never auto-decline — a low score means a human looks, not “denied.”
- Store the check results and a photo “fingerprint,” never the raw photo.

Risks and how we handle them

What could go wrong	How we handle it
Dark or blurry photo	Caught on the phone before sending; ask for a clearer one.
Camera blocked or missing	A simple upload option instead.
Network drops mid-claim	Clear retry — the claim isn't lost.
Same photo reused across accounts	A photo fingerprint matches it and flags it for review.
Real customer re-uploads on their own order	Allowed, not punished.
Photo check unsure or offline	Fall back to simpler checks plus a human; refunds are never fully blocked.

How we'd roll it out

Go-to-market

- 1 Start in one high-abuse category (fresh / grocery) on one platform.
- 2 Run in shadow mode first: score claims but don't act — tune on real data.
- 3 Turn on instant refunds for high-trust claims; review the rest.
- 4 Expand category by category as accuracy holds up.

Roadmap

Now

Trust score, photo checks, reused-photo detection, instant decisions, audit trail.

Next

Sharper photo checks, faster photo matching at scale, an agent review screen.

Later

Learn from agent decisions; tune by region and category.